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Outlook for October 2026

1. Current Meteorological Conditions

Below-normal rainfall was observed across most parts of the country during September 2026. Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Punjab, however, received rainfall close to the climatological normal record. Gilgit-Baltistan, Balochistan, and Sindh remained predominantly dry, with Sindh experiencing particularly deficient rainfall during the month and receiving only trace amounts at isolated locations. Three rainfall spells affected the country during September, with their impacts mainly concentrated over the northern and upper parts, while the southern half of the country experienced comparatively little rainfall. Meanwhile, temperatures remained above normal across most parts of the country, with the largest positive temperature anomalies recorded over Balochistan, followed by Sindh during September 2026 (**Table 1**).

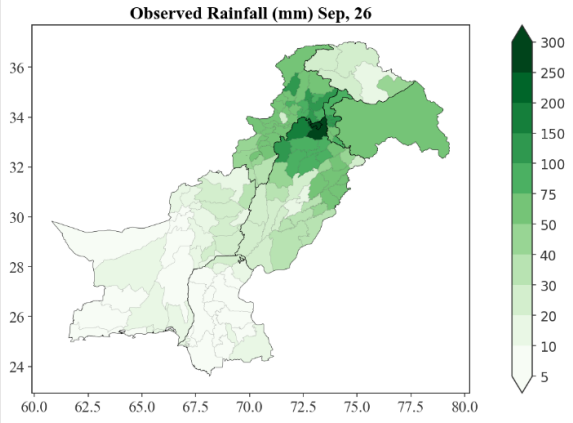


Figure 1 Observed Rainfall September 2026

Table 1: Summary of September 2026 Observed Rainfall and Temperature

Region	Total Rainfall (mm)	Normal* Rainfall (mm)	Rainfall Departure (%)	Mean Temp (°C)	Anomaly (°C)
Pakistan	20.6	29.3	-29.6	29.0	1.0
AJK	49.5	72.2	-31.5	23.1	0.6
Balochistan	2.8	8.6	-67.9	29.5	1.4
Gilgit-Baltistan	11.4	17.0	-32.7	21.3	0.3
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	53.2	54.8	-3.0	26.1	0.5
Punjab	46.8	49.7	-5.7	30.5	0.6
Sindh	3.2	31.1	-89.5	31.7	1.1

* Normal Period (1991 – 2020)

2. Monthly Rainfall Outlook:

The monthly outlook is derived from the ensemble mean of 10 selected global seasonal prediction models, providing the principal guidance for operational rainfall and temperature forecasts. Current model projections indicate the persistence of positive El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) conditions through October 2026, alongside continued positive IOD conditions over the Indian Ocean, although ENSO and IOD may exert partly compensating influences on precipitation over Pakistan. Nevertheless, based on these analyses, the model outlook indicates **near-normal to above-normal*** rainfall over the northern parts of the country, particularly northern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, adjoining parts of Gilgit-Baltistan, Azad Jammu and Kashmir and northern Punjab during October 2026. Near normal to slightly below normal rainfall is anticipated across central to southern parts of the country with the most pronounced negative anomalies expected over southern parts of Sindh. Overall, the outlook indicates a clear north–south gradient in rainfall anomalies with chances of isolated rainfall events mostly over the northern half of the country during October 2026 (**Figures 2 and 3**).

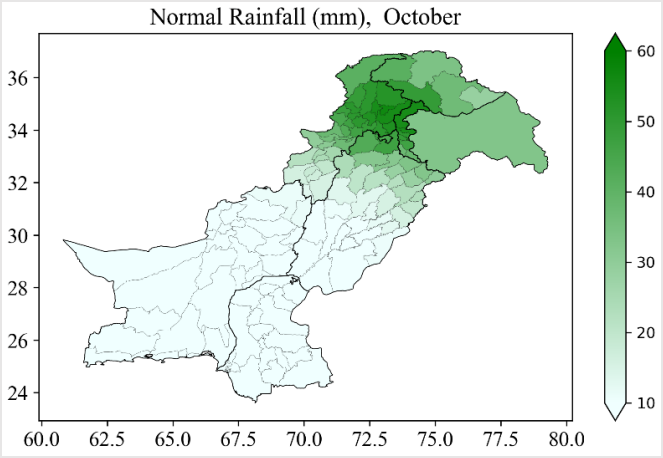


Figure 2: Normal rainfall for October (Model-Based)

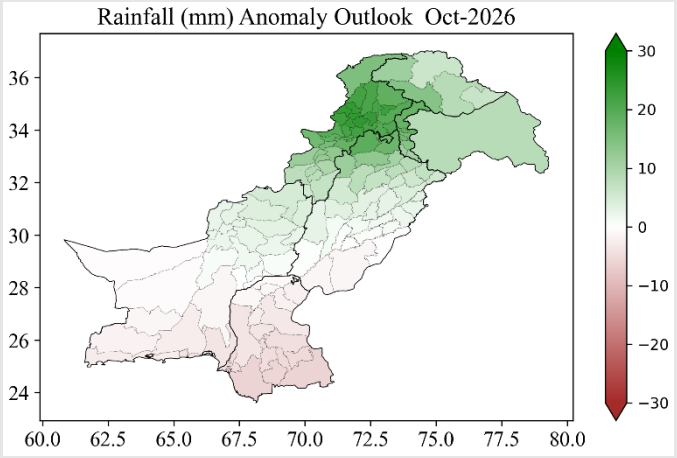


Figure 3: Projected monthly rainfall anomaly for October 2026

The probabilistic rainfall outlook reflects the overall consensus among the models included in the ensemble. The corresponding tercile probability forecast (**Figure 4**) indicates a pronounced likelihood of **above-normal** rainfall over northern and western parts of the country, particularly Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Gilgit-Baltistan, AJK, northwestern Punjab and northern Balochistan. The likelihood of normal rainfall is indicated over parts of southern Pakistan, particularly Sindh, southern Balochistan and southern Punjab, while below normal rainfall is likely over southeastern parts of Sindh during October 2026.

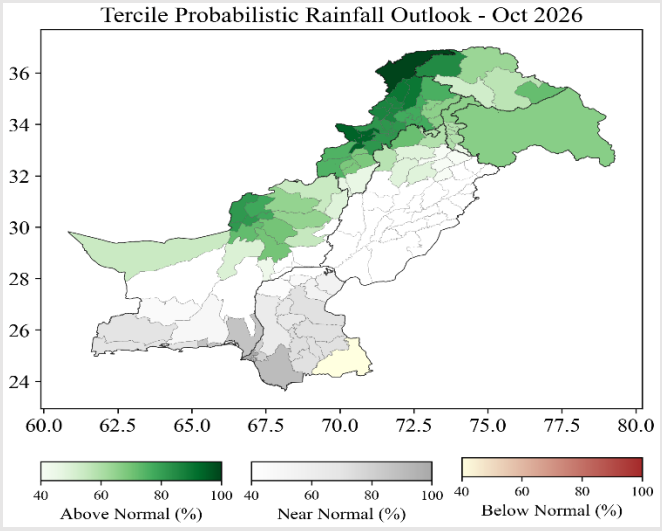


Figure 4: Probabilistic rainfall outlook for October 2026

* Normal = 30-years average climatology

3. Monthly Temperature Outlook:

Mean temperatures are expected to remain **above normal*** nationwide, with maximum departure over Gilgit-Baltistan and western parts of Balochistan in October 2026 **(Figure 5, 6)**.

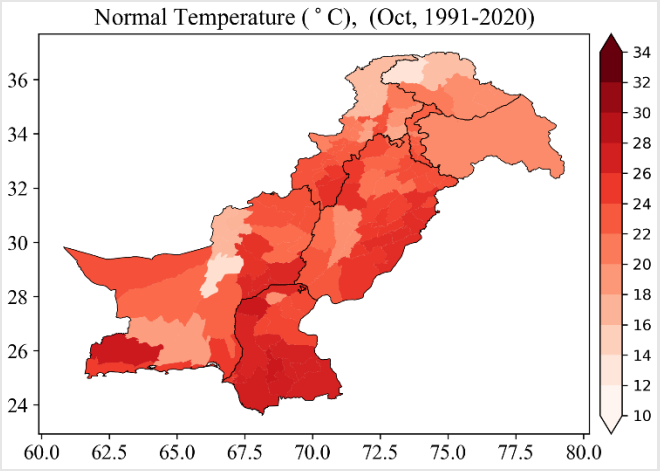


Figure 5: Normal (1991-2020) temperature for October

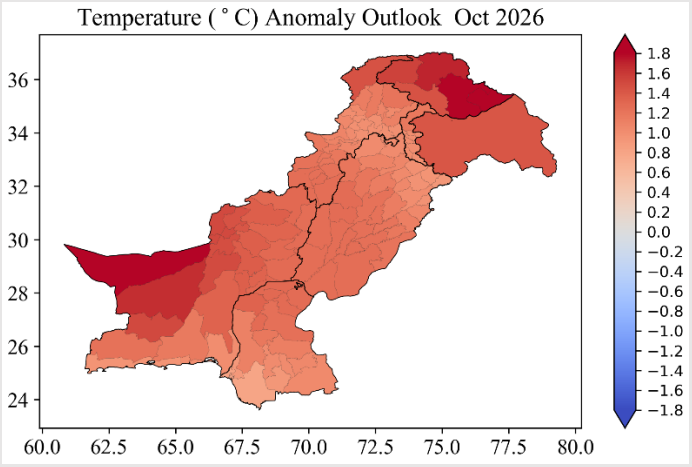


Figure 6: Monthly temperature anomaly outlook for October 2026

The tercile-based probabilistic temperature outlook (**Figure 7**) suggests a predominant probability of above-normal temperature across most parts of the country during October 2026. The highest probabilities for above normal temperatures are likely to prevail over northern areas, particularly Gilgit-Baltistan, adjoining northern Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Kashmir, as well as parts of southern Punjab and northern Sindh.

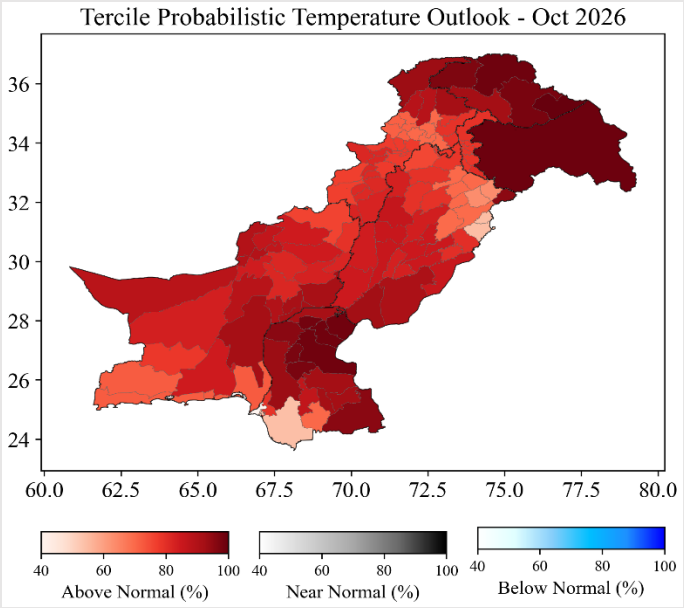


Figure 7: Probabilistic temperature outlook for October 2026

4. Impacts:

- Dry weather conditions in southern regions are favorable for the post-harvest activities of Kharif crops, particularly rice, cotton, maize and groundnut.
- Above-normal temperatures in upper glaciated regions may contribute to higher than normal flows at vulnerable locations, although the overall probability remains low.
- Spatial temperature gradient may cause strong winds, dust storms, thunderstorm and hailstorms which may affect seasonal crops, vegetables, and orchards; farmers are advised to take precautionary measures to protect standing crops.
- Isolated showers, hailstorms and strong winds may occasionally disrupt Kharif post-harvesting and early Rabi sowing activities.
- Warm and humid environment would support the breeding of Dengue larva in central Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and northwestern parts of Punjab. Dengue outbreak due to stagnant water is likely in inundated areas.
- Dry conditions, coupled with above-normal temperatures, may contribute to deteriorating air quality and smog formation over the central and southern plains and urban centers of the country, potentially posing health risks to sensitive groups, particularly children and the elderly.
- Advisory for general public:
    - Farmers are advised to visit PMD advisories on website before irrigation or sowing
    - Travelers and tourists are advised to remain cautious while travelling during rainfall events.
    - Subscribe PMD Channels on WhatsApp Application to remain updated with changing weather conditions.

Note: The seasonal outlook is updated monthly in the first week of the month. The forecast reliability varies with location, time of year, and global ocean/atmospheric conditions. It provides general trends using probabilities rather than precise predictions and compares expected conditions to historical averages. For better decision-making, it should be used alongside short-term forecasts and other climate data issued by PMD.